Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

Social Security Number

Jump to a Section

What Is a Social Security Number?

A Social Security number (SSN) is a nine-digit number issued by the U.S. Social Security Administration (SSA) to U.S. citizens, permanent residents and certain nonimmigrants authorized to work in the United States, including some F-1 and J-1 students and scholars. The SSN is primarily used for employment and tax reporting purposes.

Under current regulations, F-1 and J-1 students and scholars may obtain an SSN only if they have valid employment authorization. F-2 dependents are not eligible for an SSN because they are not authorized to work in the United States. J-2 dependents m nt authorization from U.S. Citizenship and Imm

On-campus employment generally refers to Services. Children's Hospital Los Angeles (CHLA) and H filiated with USC; therefore, qualifying employment at CH mpl nt.

Need help?

Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

Social Security Administration Offices Near Campus

The Social Security Administration office closest to the USC University Park Campus is at:

1122 W. Washington Blvd., Second Floor
Los Angeles, CA 90015
1-800-772-1213

The Social Security Administration office clo

215 N. Soto Street
Los Angeles, CA 90033
1-800-772-1213

e visiting an office, students are encour quirements
the Social Security Administration.

Need help?

Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

What to Do If You Believe Your Identity Has Been Stolen

Back to Top

Credit History

In the United States, a credit history shows an individual's past record of paying bills, loans and more, and is used to verify that they are financially responsible. Although it was never its intended purpose, the SSN became the requested identification number for checking personal credit history in the United States. It is still commonly requested when applying for an apartment, opening financial accounts or setting up services. Landlords, banks and service providers use SSNs to obtain credit history reports.

Students and scholars who are not eligible to obtain a SSN probably don't have a credit history in the United States; as a result, they may be asked [illegible] services or be restricted in the type of bank accounts the[illegible]r does not meet the eligibility requirements to be grant[illegible]edit purposes.

[illegible]to Establish a Credit History in the Un[illegible]

Need help?

Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

USC

Office of International Services

Employment & Taxes | Students

Back to Top

Frequently Asked Questions

Do F-1/J-1 students and scholars need an SSN to register for classes at USC?

Do F-1/J-1 students and scholars need an SSN to open a bank account?

Do F-1/J-1 students and scholars need an SSN to apply for a California driver's license?

Do F-1/J-1 students and scholars need an SSN to apply for housing or open utility accounts like cable or cellphone service?

Do F-1/J-1 students and scholars need an SSN application and proper work authorization

Need help?

Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

Related Pages

U.S. Taxes

Individual Taxpayer Identification Number

Back to Top

USC University of Southern California

Address:
Royal Street Structure, Suite 101
649 West 34th St.
Los Angeles, CA 90089-1626

Need help?



Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?

Important Update

2026-09-14 00:00:00

On September 14, 2026, the U.S. District Court for the District of Massachusetts issued an order pausing the effective date of the Department of Homeland Security's Duration of Status Final Rule while litigation concerning the rule continues.

LEARN MORE

USC

Office of International Services

Employment & Taxes | Students

Privacy Notice

Notice of Non-Discrimination

Digital Accessibility

Smoke-Free Policy

Copyright © 2026 University of Southern California

Need help?



Hi there! I'm Tommy, and I am here to answer your questions. What can I help with?